

RF-100 — Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) Commitment

Remnant Fieldworks Inc.

STATUS: DRAFT — for public review only

This IPR commitment is a **DRAFT** published alongside the RF-100 v1.0 Public Review Draft. It has been revised to incorporate a pre-counsel legal review (v0.2-draft) but has **NOT** yet completed formal legal/patent counsel review. It remains subject to revision, and the binding version will be published before any RF-100 certification or conformance program (RF-101 / RF-102) is launched. Until then, treat this document as a statement of intended posture, not a final, executed covenant. No reliance representation is made beyond what a public review draft supports.

Open action items requiring counsel / company action before this becomes binding are listed in Annex IPR-A at the end of this document.

Draft version: 0.2-draft (accompanies RF-100 v1.0 Public Review Draft; incorporates pre-counsel review of July 16, 2026)

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Purpose

RF-100 is intended to be an **open, implementable standard**. Remnant Fieldworks Inc. (“Remnant”) wants any party to be able to build, use, and distribute systems that conform to RF-100 without fear of a patent ambush — while Remnant retains the right to protect its **brands, products, hosted services, reference code, and certification authority** from misappropriation.

This document describes the intended patent posture for RF-100. It addresses **patent rights only**. The specification **text** license (CC BY 4.0) and the trademark position are stated separately in RF-100 Section 0.1 and are not altered or expanded by this document.

0. Definitions

For purposes of this commitment:

- **“Remnant”** means Remnant Fieldworks Inc., an Ohio corporation, and its **successors and assigns**.

- **“Remnant Patents”** means any patent claims that Remnant **owns or Controls** and that would necessarily be infringed by implementing the Normative Requirements of a released version of RF-100. It does not include claims reading on Reserved Fields (Section 3) except to the extent those claims are necessarily infringed by a Conforming Implementation of the Normative Requirements.
- **“Control” / “Controlled”** means the right to grant a covenant or license of the scope described here without the payment of consideration to, or the consent of being unreasonably withheld by, an unrelated third party.
- **“Normative Requirements”** means the individually numbered MUST / MUST NOT / SHALL / SHALL NOT / SHOULD / SHOULD NOT / MAY requirements of a specific, released version of RF-100, as published by Remnant (see RF-100 Annex D and the RF-101 conformance clause).
- **“Conforming Implementation”** means a product or system that meets the Normative Requirements of a released version of RF-100 and does not misrepresent its conformance.
- **“Implementer”** means any party that makes, has made, uses, sells, offers to sell, imports, or distributes a Conforming Implementation, together with that party’s suppliers, distributors, and customers acting in that capacity.
- **“Reserved Fields”** has the meaning in Section 3.

1. Patent Grant (Royalty-Free, Worldwide, Scoped, Reciprocal) — intended

Subject to finalization after counsel review, Remnant intends to covenant that it will **not assert** any Remnant Patents against any Implementer, anywhere in the world, for that Implementer’s making, having made, use, sale, offer for sale, importation, or distribution of a **Conforming Implementation** of a released version of RF-100, provided all of the following hold:

1. **Conformance.** The implementation meets the Normative Requirements of a released RF-100 version and does not extend, modify, or misrepresent those requirements in a way that fragments interoperability or misattributes the standard.
2. **Reciprocity (defensive termination).** The Implementer (and its affiliates) does not initiate or voluntarily join a patent assertion against Remnant, its customers, or other Implementers relating to RF-100 or to any Conforming Implementation. This covenant terminates automatically, as to any party that initiates such an assertion, as of the date the assertion is filed.
3. **Good faith.** The implementation is bona fide technical work, not an attempt to appropriate Remnant’s trade secrets, proprietary code, trademarks, service marks, or trade dress.

No royalties or fees are required for the covenant in this Section.

1A. Binding effect, irrevocability, and beneficiaries — intended

1. **Runs with the patents.** This covenant is intended to be a **binding encumbrance that runs with the Remnant Patents**. Any assignment, sale, exclusive license, or other transfer of a Remnant Patent shall be **made subject to this covenant**, and Remnant shall require each transferee to assume it in writing for the benefit of Implementers. A transferee takes subject to this covenant whether or not it expressly assumes it.
 2. **Successors and assigns.** This covenant binds Remnant's successors and assigns, including any acquirer of Remnant or of the Remnant Patents, and any entity into which Remnant is merged or reorganized.
 3. **Irrevocability / version lock.** For each **released version** of RF-100, the covenant published with that version is intended to be **irrevocable and perpetual as to implementations of that version**. Remnant may revise this commitment only **prospectively for future RF-100 versions**; a revision does not diminish the covenant already attached to a previously released version.
 4. **Third-party beneficiaries.** Implementers are intended **third-party beneficiaries** of this covenant and, once finalized, are intended to be entitled to rely on and enforce it according to its terms.
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2. What is NOT covered by this grant

This patent commitment is intended to apply **only** to Conforming Implementations of the RF-100 Normative Requirements. Remnant reserves all rights to enforce its intellectual property against, without limitation:

- **Non-conforming or derivative systems** that copy Remnant's proprietary ExecutionProof™, VaultProof™, or ProofRecord™ products, code, UI, or services without implementing RF-100, or while misrepresenting conformance.
- **Patent-assertion entities** and other parties that assert patents against Remnant, its customers, or the RF-100 ecosystem (see Section 1(2)).
- **Trademark infringement, trade-dress violation, or false endorsement** (e.g., use of Remnant's brand names or program marks, or creation of confusingly similar products).
- **Trade-secret misappropriation or unauthorized copying** of Remnant's hosted platform, reference-implementation source code, or internal tooling.

Certification under RF-101 / RF-102 and use of "RF-100 Certified by Remnant Fieldworks" or similar program marks require **separate written authorization** and are **not** granted by this commitment.

3. Reserved Fields — Trademarks, Software, and Services

The following are **Reserved Fields**. No rights are granted by this document to:

- **Marks:** Remnant Fieldworks™, ExecutionProof™, VaultProof™, ProofRecord™, Proof Before Power™, and Verification Before Execution™, and any RF-100 conformance/program marks — as trademarks or service marks. (The legal structure of any conformance-certification program and its marks — including whether it is operated through an independent certifying body — is a **pending item; see Annex IPR-A**. These are referred to here as “program marks,” not as statutory “certification marks,” pending that determination.)
- **Software & services:** Remnant’s hosted services, APIs, reference-implementation code, documentation, and trade secrets.
- **Program assets:** Remnant’s conformance/certification program, training materials, and conformance-testing tools.

These remain the exclusive property of Remnant Fieldworks Inc. and are licensed separately under commercial or open-source terms as applicable.

4. Specification Text License (cross-reference)

The **text** of the RF-100 specification is made available under **CC BY 4.0** (Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International), as stated in RF-100 Section 0.1. This IPR commitment addresses **patent rights only** and does not alter or expand the CC BY 4.0 license or grant any trademark rights.

5. No Implied Rights; No Exhaustion Beyond Express Covenant

No rights are granted by implication, estoppel, or otherwise except the express covenant in Section 1. The covenant is **not** a license to any Remnant Patent for non-conforming uses or for any Reserved Field, and confers no rights with respect to activities outside the making, using, or distributing of a Conforming Implementation.

6. No Warranty / Limitation of Liability

This commitment, when finalized, will be made without warranty of any kind. Remnant does not warrant that implementing RF-100 will avoid infringing third-party patents outside Remnant’s Control, and Implementers assume all risk and responsibility for their own IP clearance.

7. Governing Law

This commitment, when finalized, is intended to be governed by the laws of the **State of Ohio, U.S.A.**, without regard to conflict-of-laws principles, and the parties intend the state and federal courts located in Ohio to be the forum for any dispute (subject to any arbitration provision counsel may add in the binding version).

8. Versioning

The effective version of this commitment for any implementation is the version published at the time the corresponding RF-100 version was released (see the version-lock rule in Section 1A(3)). This draft (0.2-draft) accompanies the RF-100 v1.0 Public Review Draft and will be superseded by a counsel-reviewed version prior to any certification launch.

Annex IPR-A — Open action items before this commitment becomes binding

(Informative. These require company/counsel action and cannot be resolved by the drafting of this document alone.)

1. **Patent-prosecutor coordination (56 pending applications).** Confirm the scope of “Remnant Patents” against the actual pending portfolio, preserve claim scope for the Reserved Fields intended for monetization, and address any estoppel/dedication and continuation-strategy considerations.
 2. **Certification-mark structure.** Decide whether the conformance program uses ordinary trademarks/service marks or statutory certification marks, and whether certification must be operated through a body independent of Remnant’s commercial offerings (U.S. certification-mark anti-use rules).
 3. **Corporate authorization.** Obtain board / sole-director authorization (Ohio Rev. Code Ch. 1701) for the final covenant, and execute it with corporate signing authority.
 4. **Patent-marking accuracy.** Verify the accuracy and count of any “patent pending” statement before it is published in the binding version.
 5. **Governing-law / dispute-resolution finalization.** Confirm Ohio governing law and decide on venue vs. arbitration.
 6. **CC BY 4.0 present-tense alignment.** Ensure the spec-text license grant is present and effective (not aspirational) in the binding version, consistent with RF-100 Section 0.1.
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Contact

Questions regarding this IPR commitment should be directed to:

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Remnant Fieldworks Inc.

© 2026 Remnant Fieldworks Inc. This IPR commitment draft may be quoted and cited for review purposes. Trademarks are the property of Remnant Fieldworks Inc. Patent applications pending (count/status to be verified per Annex IPR-A).